

Chemical Engineering Faculty Meeting December 2nd, 2016

Attendees

1. Christos Takoudis
2. Michael Caracotsios
3. Betul Bilgin
4. Alan Zdunek
5. Sultana Ferdous
6. Sangil Kim
7. Brian Chaplin
8. Shafigh Mehraeen
9. Meenesh Singh
10. Yijing Kang
11. Gang Cheng
12. Ying Liu
13. Ludwig Nitsche
14. Vikas Berry
15. Tiesha Burnett
16. Roberto Rodriguez

Agenda

Minutes Approval

- Revisions for 9.23.16 meeting: Correct spelling of Alan Zdunek's name & full explanation for what option 2B

Welcome & Updates

- New Hires: Roberto Rodriguez (Business Manager); Sanjay Bhura (Visiting Research Assistant Professor), Yijin Kang (Adjunct Research Professor)
- Building updates: no change in square footage; computer lab space added. Expected Move Date- Dec. 2018 (there will be a 2 year transition to get all machinery moved to the new location)
- China Update: Harbin Institute of Technology (H.I.T) has been added to the China program. Currently have 6 students for Spring 2017 and 11 for Fall 2017
- AICHE Receptions- will be an annual event held at the same hotel or somewhere close to where the conference is being held. The idea is to increase foot traffic. Meenesh Singh and Gang Cheng are the appointed coordinators for the upcoming AICHE Reception.
- Research Symposium- Sanjay Behura will take the lead on coordinating the department research symposium. Going forward we are going to invite industry people and potentially combine Industry Day with Research Symposiums. The topics to focus on will be Complex Fluids and Soft matter
- Policy Memos: Purchasing and Travel Arrangements will be streamlined. Roberto will send memos out via email on Dec. 5th.
- Audit: The department received an Orange warning. After meeting with auditors, we have everything in place to correct the errors.

Report DUGS Office

- Application/Enrollment- no updates
- Course Updates: CHE 494 was approved to be a permanent course (CHEM 451)
- School Visits by Faculty: College of DuPage (Explorer Night), Buffalo Grove High School (Career Night) Going forward, each faculty member is required to reach out to 2 High Schools to coordinate an event where we can promote the Chemical Engineering Dept., in efforts to increase enrollments. The hope is to target AP classes, connect with teachers and explain what Chemical Engineering is.
- Upcoming Events: Midwest Regional Conference – in need of student volunteers
- AIChE Student Chapter News: Chem E Car moving along well; documents due by early Feb. Recent Events (Gelita Plant Tour, Bar Crawl and Study Night)

Report DGS Office

- Comments on Posters: suggestion made to send the posters to schools and other departments
- Updates from the Graduate Committee: CHE 410 is not considered a 500 level course.

Seminar Updates

- Spring Semester Updates: lots of open slots left
- Saxena Award: need nominations for a distinguished speaker for next year.

WISEST- No updates

COE-Executive Committee – (Ludwig Nitsche) no updates

- Upcoming Events: Grants & Application workshop (Date: TBD early spring)